AI Sales Intelligence — Evaluation Findings Report

Two complementary tests of rule-based qualification and evidence-grounded commercial research

Assessment: 1–2 November 2026 | Four AI platforms | Ten UK hospitality brands

At a glance

Experiment A tested closed-book rubric application. Across 40 model–company evaluations, all 40 scores and all 40 priority labels matched the supplied reference. This shows accurate application of the specified rules in one run per model; it does not test independent research.
Experiment B tested independent commercial research. After a single-reviewer audit, scores ranged from 31/100 to 73/100. These results describe the saved outputs under the project rubric and should not be read as general model rankings.
Practical takeaway: AI can accelerate account research and sales hypotheses, but source quality, venue scope, incumbent systems, buying authority and transaction eligibility still require human verification.

Experiment A — Rule-Based Lead Qualification: Final Findings

Evaluation date: 1 November 2026 | Prompt version: A-v1 | Scope: four AI platforms, ten UK restaurant brands

Executive summary

Four AI platforms—ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and DeepSeek—each completed one run of the same fixed-rubric B2B lead qualification task. Across 40 model–company evaluations, all 40 total scores and all 40 priority classifications matched the reference dataset. Every model achieved 100% accuracy and a mean absolute scoring error of 0. The supplied rationales were consistent with the rubric and input data, with no unsupported company facts identified in the recorded outputs.

This is evidence of accurate application of a clearly specified scoring formula in this limited sample. It is not evidence that the models can independently research companies, judge commercial attractiveness or reliably perform on less constrained tasks.

Research objective and design

Research question: Can general-purpose AI models apply a predefined ideal-customer-profile (ICP) rubric to ten UK hospitality operators without arithmetic, classification or instruction-following errors?

Design: Single-run, zero-shot comparison across four AI platforms. Each model received ten restaurant names, UK same-brand location counts, verified additional UK openings and identical scoring instructions. Reference answers and commercial evaluation notes were withheld. The task specified using only the provided information and not conducting external research.

The evaluation compared each model's location points, expansion points, total score, High/Medium/Low classification and explanation against the Human Scores reference tab. The reported accuracy metrics reflect agreement with that reference, not independent verification of each underlying business fact.

Fixed qualification rubric

Location points: 1 UK location = 0; 2–4 = 20; 5–9 = 40; 10 or more = 60.

Expansion points: 0 verified additional openings = 0; 1 = 25; 2 or more = 40.

Total score = location points + expansion points, maximum 100. Priority: High = 80–100; Medium = 40–79; Low = 0–39.

Reference dataset and expected outcomes

Dishoom — 13 locations; 2 openings; 100 points; High.

Hawksmoor — 11 locations; 1 opening; 85 points; High.

Blacklock — 7 locations; 1 opening; 65 points; Medium.

Pizza Pilgrims — 30 locations; 5 openings; 100 points; High.

Lina Stores — 9 locations; 0 openings; 40 points; Medium.

Mildreds — 5 locations; 0 openings; 40 points; Medium.

Manteca — 1 location; 0 openings; 0 points; Low.

Café Clement — 1 location; 0 openings; 0 points; Low.

Carbone London — 1 location; 0 openings; 0 points; Low.

Lucky Cat — 3 locations; 0 openings; 20 points; Low.

Cross-model results

ChatGPT — 10/10 total scores correct; 10/10 priority labels correct; 100%/100% accuracy; mean absolute error 0.

Claude — 10/10 total scores correct; 10/10 priority labels correct; 100%/100% accuracy; mean absolute error 0.

Gemini 3 — 10/10 total scores correct; 10/10 priority labels correct; 100%/100% accuracy; mean absolute error 0.

DeepSeek — 10/10 total scores correct; 10/10 priority labels correct; 100%/100% accuracy; mean absolute error 0.

Aggregate — 40/40 scores and 40/40 priority labels correct across the four single-run evaluations.

Key findings

1. All models successfully translated the specified UK-location and additional-opening brackets into points, performed the additions and applied the priority thresholds. This includes cases at the 40-point Medium threshold (Lina Stores and Mildreds) and zero-point Low outcomes (Manteca, Café Clement and Carbone London).

2. No model outperformed another on these measures. Identical perfect results create a ceiling effect: this experiment does not discriminate among the models' deeper reasoning capabilities.

3. The rationales largely restated the same calculations with different wording. Their correctness demonstrates consistency with supplied inputs, not independent factual investigation or strategic account insight.

Testing environment and reproducibility

All four runs are dated 1 November 2026 in the Experiment log, with one recorded run per platform and prompt version A-v1.

ChatGPT: Temporary Chat, unpersonalized; High reasoning effort; exact model version unconfirmed. An earlier report label of “GPT-6 Sol” was not independently established and is not treated as verified metadata.

Claude: Sonnet 5.5, as reported; fresh conversation; reasoning setting not recorded.

Gemini: Gemini 3; precise variant and reasoning setting not recorded.

DeepSeek: version not confirmed; the Experiment log describes a fresh conversation and DeepThink as settings requiring verification, not as confirmed conditions.

The prompt, reference scores, verbatim model rationales, per-company match flags and experiment metadata should be retained together to enable reproducibility. The original AI responses are stored in separate model-results tabs.

Limitations and validity

Small sample and repeated-run uncertainty: only ten companies and one run per model were tested. These 100% scores cannot be generalized to different prompts, stochastic repeats or other model versions.

Supplied data, not independently researched facts: the models were given restaurant counts and expansion figures. The study did not test browsing, source checking or hallucination resistance during open-ended research. Some source data, including specific location counts, require ongoing reconciliation; “zero verified openings” means none were established in this dataset, not proof that no openings occurred.

Narrow scoring dimensions: the rubric excludes profitability, software compatibility, buying authority, parent-company ownership, brand positioning, willingness to pay and likely

contract value. Consequently, a Low score is not necessarily a Low-value commercial prospect.

Evaluation independence: the reference outcomes follow the researcher's fixed rubric, and the rationale review was not independently blind-adjudicated. The wider commercial notes were developed with AI assistance and should not be presented as wholly independent human ground truth.

Conclusion and next research question

Experiment A established a reliable baseline in this fixed, closed-book qualification exercise: four model runs, forty correct company scores, forty correct priority labels and no observed arithmetic errors. Because every model reached the ceiling, the next study should evaluate genuinely differentiated skills—evidence-grounded commercial reasoning, parent-group opportunities, software-fit hypotheses, competitive risks and uncertainty—under a separately defined Experiment B protocol.

Source record: AI Sales Evaulation Data Set (Human Scores, Experiment log, Experiment A ChatGPT Results, Experiment A Claude Results, Experiment A Gemini Results and Experiment A Deepseek tabs).

Experiment B — Independent Commercial Research and Sales Judgment: Audited Findings

Assessment date: 1 November 2026 | Audit date: 2 November 2026 | Prompt: B-v2 | One run per platform | UK hospitality accounts

Executive summary

Experiment B evaluated whether four AI systems could independently research ten UK restaurant brands and turn incomplete public evidence into defensible B2B SaaS sales recommendations for the fictional GuestFlow product. Unlike Experiment A, where every model received the same verified counts and applied a deterministic rubric correctly, Experiment B required source discovery, commercial interpretation, risk awareness and actionable account strategy.

After a single-reviewer evidence audit and score calibration, DeepSeek DeepThink received 73/100, Claude 70/100, ChatGPT 62/100 and Gemini 31/100. These are scores for the tested platform-and-research configurations in one run each, not general rankings of model capability. More complete source discovery did not guarantee better commercial judgment: several persuasive proposals were weakened by inaccurate location counts, overlooked incumbent technology, or unsupported assumptions about paid experiences.

Research question and experimental design

Question: Given identical high-level information about a hypothetical restaurant guest-intelligence SaaS product, which AI research configuration identifies verifiable,

economically meaningful prospect opportunities while separating fact from inference? Each system received the same B-v2 brief, the same ten restaurant names and an assessment date of 1 November 2026. It was instructed to browse independently and produce a ten-company research table, commercial evaluation TSV, ranking, overlooked-account cases, sales execution strategies, hybrid-pricing analysis and a source register. The human-directed reference research and detailed scoring notes were withheld from the tested prompts.

GuestFlow's hypothetical subscription pricing was £300 per customer group per month, plus £350 per participating venue per month, with optional premium analytics at £150 per venue per month. The optional transaction module charges 2% only on eligible prepaid experiences processed through GuestFlow. Subscription ARR is 12 × (£300 + £350 × participating venues + £150 × analytics venues); transaction revenue is variable, not ARR. A one-venue base contract is £7,800 per year. No model had verified a restaurant's willingness to buy, GuestFlow transaction volumes, or full group-wide procurement rights.

Rubric, independent audit and score provenance

A single reviewer assessed each of ten accounts on five dimensions, each scored 0–2 points: (1) research accuracy and source quality; (2) commercial reasoning and product fit; (3) strategic account awareness; (4) risks and uncertainty; and (5) actionable sales intelligence. Thus each account could earn 10 points and each model 100. A zero means materially unreliable or missing, one means plausible but materially incomplete, and two means sufficiently specific, evidence-grounded and commercially sound for that dimension. Where a research mistake led to a distinct commercial error, it could affect more than one dimension, with the reason recorded.

The reference research was treated as a human-directed, AI-assisted benchmark, not infallible human-only ground truth. Corrections and disputed evidence were recorded in B Fact Verification rather than automatically counting departures from the reference as model errors. B Source Audit samples one material claim per account per model (40 records); B Citation Verification separately examines source-register traceability; B Score Calibration records the original and audited rubric scores and reasons. Original model outputs and initial scorecards were preserved.

Audited cross-model scores

DeepSeek DeepThink — 73/100; research 11/20, commercial 13/20, strategic 14/20, risk 16/20, actionable 19/20. Original provisional score: 74/100.

Claude — 70/100; research 10/20, commercial 11/20, strategic 15/20, risk 17/20, actionable 17/20. Original provisional score: 74/100.

ChatGPT — 62/100; research 6/20, commercial 13/20, strategic 11/20, risk 16/20, actionable 16/20. Original provisional score: 73/100.

Gemini — 31/100; research 1/20, commercial 9/20, strategic 7/20, risk 3/20, actionable 11/20. Original provisional score: 41/100.

Differences should be read as descriptive differences in a small, subjectively adjudicated sample. In particular, a three-point gap between DeepSeek and Claude is not robust evidence of superiority. Research environments, search capabilities and model settings were not fully verified for all platforms.

Key findings

1. Incumbent discovery can reverse the sales thesis. DeepSeek found Hawksmoor's existing Distil guest-data and CRM integration, alongside OpenTable and a rewards programme. This substantially narrows the case for selling another generic guest-intelligence layer: GuestFlow would need a validated incremental capability. The prior reference log did not capture Distil, so this was credited as a genuinely useful model discovery, not marked wrong for disagreeing with the reference.
2. A broader group association is a hypothesis about account expansion, not proof of a common buying centre. Dishoom's L Catterton investment, Blacklock's BGF minority investor, Pizza Pilgrims' L'Osteria relationship, Lina Stores' White Rabbit Projects portfolio and Lucky Cat's Gordon Ramsay Restaurants affiliation can inform discovery. They do not by themselves justify group-level ARR forecasts or assumptions that sister brands share purchasing authority.
3. Prepaid experience evidence matters more than luxury positioning. Pizza Pilgrims advertises bookable masterclasses; Lina Stores documents a Tripleseat private-events enquiry process and terms requiring prepaid minimum-spend deposits via Stripe. By contrast, high guest spend at Manteca or Carbone does not establish an eligible transaction base. Existing deposits or payment processors also do not demonstrate that restaurants would accept an additional 2% charge.
4. Correct formulas can still produce misleading ARR. The venue counts feeding many projections were inaccurate or of uncertain scope. Several Claude examples used £4,200 as a possible one-venue annual contract despite the required £3,600 annual group fee; the correct base is £7,800. Subscription revenue assumptions must distinguish total branded venues, eligible restaurants, participating venues and optional analytics adoption.
5. Unsupported confidence is a commercial risk. Gemini labelled several accounts high confidence while undercounting sites, overlooking verified ownership changes, or making unverified claims about software providers and prepaid revenue. Its source register did not provide direct article URLs in the saved response. That contrast between fluent advice and evidence quality was a major factor in its lower audited score.
6. Models can still generate useful sales work amid imperfect research. DeepSeek's targeted discovery questions, Claude's strong Blacklock financial/expansion research, ChatGPT's identification of a Carbone London booking deposit, and multiple models' cautious differentiation of subscription and variable fees demonstrate practical strengths. Each should be checked for relevance and proof before entering a live prospect pipeline.

Fact reconciliation: Pizza Pilgrims and other material corrections

The reviewed 1 November 2025–1 November 2026 opening window contains five evidence-backed new Pizza Pilgrims branded pizzerias when compact/kiosk formats are included: King's Cross (8 Dec 2025), Glasgow (27 Apr 2026), Bristol (15 Jun 2026), Wimbledon (18 Aug 2026) and Stratford Westfield (7 Sep 2026, compact grab-and-go format). A full-service-only definition would exclude Stratford and yield four; both meet Experiment A's maximum expansion bracket of two or more openings. Soho's refurbishment is not a new restaurant opening.

The exact like-for-like operating-estate count on the 1 November assessment date was not captured consistently across sources: the human dataset records 30, while a July trade report refers to 31 and formats include concessions. At the live official-directory check on 2 November 2026, Pizza Pilgrims listed 30 pizzerias. The project therefore uses 30 as its current planning count and retains the July report's 31 as a dated discrepancy. Experiment B treated both 30 and 31 as plausible for the assessment-date comparison. This caveat does not invalidate Experiment A's fixed-rule result, which measures how models scored the dataset as supplied rather than the reference count's independent accuracy.
Additional audit discoveries incorporated into the reference include Dishoom's L Catterton investment, Hawksmoor's Distil deployment, Lina Stores' documented Stripe prepayment terms and Tripleseat enquiry technology, and Mildreds/mallow's published Lightspeed Restaurant and Payments case study. A dated vendor case study shows a historical deployment, not a guarantee of current contract status.

Citation quality and audit traceability

The saved Claude report printed 22 distinct HTTP URLs, often claim-specific. DeepSeek printed 21 URL references representing 13 distinct URLs, typically homepage or domain-level links rather than exact article destinations. The saved ChatGPT and Gemini reports printed no explicit HTTP URLs in their Part G source registers. For ChatGPT, clickable platform-native citations may have been lost when content was copied; therefore, the absence of printed URLs is a traceability limitation of the retained artefact, not proof that browsing did not occur. Some Claude links were unavailable at audit time; an inaccessible link was not automatically classified as a false factual claim.
We considered a citation's existence, its ability to resolve, and its actual evidentiary support separately. The audit is material-claim sampling plus source-register inspection, not exhaustive checking of every statement in every report. Full URLs and corresponding caveats are retained in B Citation Verification, B Source Audit and B Fact Verification.

Interpretation, limitations and next steps

This was one run per platform, assessed by one reviewer, without independent second-rater replication, blinded adjudication or statistical significance testing. Exact model versions, reasoning levels and live research settings were not consistently confirmed. The results therefore describe these four saved outputs under rubric v2.1 rather than general model skill. The evaluator's reference corpus was developed with human direction and AI assistance, creating potential shared-source and judgment bias. Restored original platform citations could change source-traceability assessments.
Experiment A's 40/40 agreement demonstrates reliable compliance with a simple scoring rule when counts are supplied. Experiment B shows why independent commercial research requires verification of provenance, buying authority, incumbent systems, venue scope, fee eligibility and price arithmetic. The strongest practical workflow is to use models to propose research directions and discovery hypotheses while keeping factual registers, qualification rules, commercial approvals and financial calculations auditable and separate.
A separate GuestFlow simulator has since been built with account-level venue assumptions, editable subscription pricing, scenario controls and an executive dashboard. Its current planning case uses 30 Pizza Pilgrims venues from the official directory and keeps transaction fees separate from subscription ARR. Eligible prepaid volume remains an

illustrative assumption, so its outputs are opportunities to explore—not a sales forecast or profit estimate.

Evidence register and reproducibility

Primary working dataset and audit trail: AI Sales Evaluation Dataset — Research, Location Audit, Events, Commercial Sources, experiment outputs and verification tabs.
Selected external evidence: Hawksmoor Distil case study; Mildreds and mallow Lightspeed case study; Lina Stores prepayment terms; Lina Stores private-event enquiry; Pizza Pilgrims masterclasses; Pizza Pilgrims expansion report.
Status: Experiment B audit complete under the stated single-reviewer standard. The assessment-date Pizza Pilgrims venue-count discrepancy, partial link retrievability and lack of independent replication remain explicit limitations.